

of malversation in his office ; and the king issued his writ, on November 3, to the Earls of Arundel, Warwick, and Huntingdon, and to John de Grey of Retherfield, his steward, and Bartholomew de Burghersh, the chamberlain, to have him before them, and to do justice according to his demerits. They immediately proceeded on their commission ; when he confessed that he had received bribes from Richard de Salteby, of 10*l.* ; from Hildebrand Bereswerd, of 20*l.* ; from Gilbert Haliland, of 40*l.* ; from Thomas de Derby of St. Bartholomew, of 20*l.* ; and from Robert de Dalderby, of 10*l.* ; all of whom had been indicted before him at Lincoln ; and that he had therefore caused the writ of exigent against them to be stayed : whereupon he was committed prisoner to the Tower of London, and all his lands and goods were ordered to be seized into the king's hands, until the royal will and pleasure should be known.

With this legal and reasonable judgment, however, the king was not satisfied ; and accordingly issued another writ on November 19, in which, after reciting the oath taken by the justices, that none of them should accept any gift or reward from any one who had a plea or process before them, it was added, that when Sir William de Thorpe took that oath, the king, "*ore tenus*," imposed such punishment, that if he in any manner acted contrary thereto, he should be adjudged to be degraded and hanged. And then, after detailing the offence with which Thorpe was charged, and his confession, and dilating on the augmented fees assigned to the judges, and their three robes a year, the king states that he is greatly moved at the judgment pronounced by the justices assigned to try him, and that they have forborne to proceed on the sentence agreed to be imposed on him. He then commands the same parties immediately to pronounce the judgment agreed upon. This was accordingly done on November 19, 1350, 24 Edward III. ; and thereupon, on the same day, the